

Your AI prompts are losing you time and results.

One framework fixes this. Works on every AI tool. Template inside.

Hi, I'm Kainat! 🙋

Today we learn **TCREI**, the prompting framework used by 500+ students in this series.

📄 Template Inside

💡 Lightbulb Slide

🧪 Lab Task



Swipe to learn all 5 steps · Scroll through all 12 slides!

Think of it like a recipe. Follow the steps and your AI output actually makes sense.

T

Task

Tell AI exactly what to do and in what format.

C

Context

Give background so AI understands your situation.

R

References

Share examples to show the style you want.

E

Evaluate

Check the output. Is it accurate and useful?

I

Iterate — Always Be Iterating (ABI)

Bad output means refine the prompt. Keep going until it actually clicks.

87%

of bad AI outputs come from a vague Task statement.

Most people skip straight to asking. **TCREI makes you think before you type.** That small pause changes everything.

You get **5x better outputs** just by adding context. The more background you give, the better AI understands you.

That is the real skill shift happening right now.

Without TCREI vs With TCREI

Same question. Completely different quality of answer.

Situation	✗ Without	✓ With TCREI
Marketing post	"Write me a post about marketing."	"Act as a social media strategist. Write a 150-word LinkedIn post for startup founders on email marketing. Conversational tone."
Science topic	"How was DNA discovered?"	"You are a science educator. Explain DNA discovery in 2 fun paragraphs for students who find science boring."
Business ideas	"Give me ideas for my business."	"I run an online clothing brand for Gen Z women. Give me 5 low-budget Instagram campaign ideas that drive sales."

Which column matches how you prompt right now?



Think of it like placing an order. The clearer the order, the better the meal you get.



Give a Persona

"Act as a business coach"



Set a Format

table, list, paragraph



Be Specific

not just "write a post"

COPY-PASTE PROMPT TEMPLATE

You are a **[expert / role]**.
Create a **[format: table / list / paragraph]**
about **[specific topic]**
for **[target audience]**.

[Claude](#)[ChatGPT](#)[Gemini](#)[Perplexity](#)



Context is the background that helps AI actually understand what you need.

1

Your Goal

What are you trying to achieve? What will you do with this output?

2

The Reason

Why are you creating this? Who is it for? What is their level?

3

Past Attempts

Share what you tried before and what did not work. This is gold.

CONTEXT IN ACTION

I am a student making a slide deck on **[climate change]**.
My audience is high schoolers who find the topic boring.
Please make it **engaging, relatable and easy to follow**.



Pasting examples is not enough. Label them clearly so AI knows exactly how to use them.

Transitional Phrase

```
"Refer to these materials..."  
"Use the following examples..."
```

Use Headings

```
Product A: [description]  
Product B: [description]
```

XML Tags

```
<example01>  
[your example here]  
</example01>
```

Markdown

```
**bold** and _italic_  
Keeps your formatting intact
```

2 to 5 references is the sweet spot. Quality beats quantity every time.

Random Prompt vs Guided Prompt

✗ Without Structure

"Write a product description for a watch."

- Vague, one-line question
- AI guesses what you want
- Generic surface-level answer
- You re-explain every time
- Charts you build by hand

✓ With TCREI

"Act as a luxury copywriter. Write a 60-word description for a scratch-resistant watch. Match this style: [example]."

- Clear persona and format
- AI knows your exact need
- Specific, useful output
- Builds on your reference
- Same data, better insight

Works on: ChatGPT | Claude | Gemini | Perplexity

Most people stop at the first output. The best results come from going back and refining.

E

Evaluate the Output

- Is it accurate and factual?
- Is it relevant to your goal?
- Does it match the format you asked for?
- Check for any bias or gaps

I

Iterate Always (ABI)

- Output is off? Refine the prompt
- Add more context or better examples
- Try a different AI tool for same task
- Keep going until it actually clicks

Bad output does not mean bad AI. The prompt usually needs work.

Best AI Tool for Each Task



Claude

Best for: Long writing, deep analysis, nuanced reasoning

Great when you need thoughtful, well-structured outputs on complex topics.



ChatGPT

Best for: Brainstorming, coding, creative ideas fast

Strong at generating diverse ideas and helping debug code quickly.



Gemini

Best for: Google Docs, Sheets and Gmail integration

Built right into your Google tools for seamless day-to-day productivity.



Perplexity

Best for: Real-time research with cited live sources

Searches the web and gives you sources. Perfect when you need current data.

TCREI works with all of them. Pick based on task, not just habit.

**Task: What do you want AI to do?**

Include persona and format. E.g. "Act as a coach. Write a 3-step action plan."

**Context: Why, for whom, and when?**

Add your goal, your audience and what has not worked before.

**References: Show, don't just tell.**

Use 2 to 5 labeled examples so AI knows the exact style you want.

**Evaluate: Is the output accurate?**

Check for bias, relevance and factual errors before using anything.

**Iterate: Always Be Iterating (ABI)**

Bad output means refine the prompt. Keep going. Every iteration gets better.

Save one good prompt template and reuse it on every task you have.

Act as a [expert role]. Create a [format]
about [topic] for [audience].
Context: [your goal + background].
Style reference: [paste your example here].

- 1 Open any AI tool you already use right now.
- 2 Think of a recent prompt that gave you a disappointing result.
- 3 Rewrite it using the TCREI template above and compare the outputs.
- 4 Notice the difference. That difference is the skill.

Which TCREI step were you skipping? Comment T, C, R, E, or I 🖱️